Most People Won't Have a Job in 18 Months

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 09, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RXJnHVPQRyg Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

AI automation is set to devastate employment across every income and education level within 18–24 months, triggering social unrest and economic collapse. The speakers argue that owning hard assets and selling options contracts are the primary ways to protect and grow wealth through the chaos.

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🤖 The AI Job Apocalypse Is Already Underway 0:23

- Major layoffs are happening weekly or even daily and accelerating
  - Barclays laid off approximately **5,000 people** (5% of their ~100,000-person workforce), with more cuts expected
  - Kroger announced thousands of layoffs as well
- The pattern is businesses replacing humans with automation to improve profit margins
  - Fewer human errors, lower labor costs, higher margins — a strong financial incentive to automate
- Entry-level and trade jobs are the first to go
  - Taxi and Uber drivers will be replaced by autonomous vehicles
  - Fast food workers and cashiers are disappearing
- The timeline for systemic breakdown: **18 to 24 months**, possibly as fast as 2–3 days once dominoes start falling
  - "I don't think it's three years."
- The speakers recall the moment ChatGPT launched as the clear signal: "Oh, fuck. It's the countdown."

🎓 White-Collar and Educated Workers Are Most at Risk 1:55

- Counterintuitively, **grad school and professional degrees offer the least protection**
  - Any knowledge-based, standardized role is highly automatable
  - AI can perform accounting better than a human — across multiple jurisdictions and countries simultaneously, not just local or state-by-state
- Professions facing mass unemployment:
  - Accountants
  - Low-level attorneys
  - Investment bankers
  - Consultants
  - Medical professionals (especially doctors — see next section)
- The displacement cascades downward: high-IQ, hardworking professionals (doctors, lawyers, bankers) will compete for the remaining lower-skilled jobs
  - They will accept pay cuts to stay employed
  - This squeezes out everyone below them
  - Result: a large population with no jobs at all
- The concept of a **"permanent underclass"** — people so far behind they can never recover
  - "They climb the ladder and then the ladder gets yanked up with them."

👨‍⚕️ Nurses vs. Doctors: Who Actually Has Job Security 2:40

- Doctors are more replaceable than nurses — a surprising inversion of conventional status
  - Doctors primarily perform **diagnosis** — a knowledge-based, pattern-recognition task AI can replicate or surpass
  - Nurses perform **hands-on human interaction**: helping patients bathe, providing physical care, emotional support
- Physical, human-contact-intensive work is harder to automate than intellectual work
- The broader principle: tasks requiring human presence and dexterity in unpredictable real-world settings retain value longer than tasks that are essentially information processing

📉 The Economic Doom Loop: Unemployment → Welfare → Inflation → Collapse 3:50

- Mass unemployment leads directly to political pressure for expanded welfare programs
  - When more people are on welfare than are paying taxes, the fiscal math breaks down
- The U.S. already carries a **$40 trillion national debt**

- To fund welfare without income tax revenue, the government must sell bonds → money supply expands → **massive inflation**
  - "Who's going to pay the debt back if people don't have jobs?"
- Alternative: taxing businesses (robots/automation) doesn't work either
  - Businesses require consumers with money to survive
  - If consumers are broke, businesses collapse regardless of tax policy
  - "You don't have an income tax if there's no income."
- The whole system is self-reinforcing in the wrong direction: no jobs → no taxes → no welfare funding → social unrest → no consumers → business failures

> "It simply doesn't work over time. This all breaks down in 18 months, 24 months."

💳 How Banks Will Make It Worse: The Credit Limit Trap 5:24

- When banks see economic deterioration, they will proactively slash credit limits
  - Example: someone with a $50,000 credit limit using $10,000 (20% utilization) may have their limit reduced to $11,000 — leaving only $1,000 available
  - That person goes from thinking they have **$40,000 in credit cushion** to having **$1,000 — 2.5% of what they assumed**
- The idea of "selling your car" as a fallback also collapses
  - Autonomous vehicles reduce demand for personal cars
  - Everyone else is also broke and can't buy your car
- Assets people think of as safety nets (savings, used cars, credit headroom) evaporate simultaneously

🏠 Who Wins: Asset Owners and the Inflation Hedge 6:33

- If you own **premium real estate**, inflation is your friend
  - Your fixed debt stays the same in nominal terms but shrinks in real terms as property values inflate
  - "The numerical debt in real terms becomes minuscule relative to the value of the inflated price of the property."
- Owning **high-quality companies** insulates you from inflation similarly
- **Utilities** are singled out as the most bulletproof category
  - Electricity, natural gas, water — people pay these no matter what
  - Even a 40% increase in the electric bill gets paid; people won't "live in the dark"
  - "Critical infrastructure" assets will continue to generate income regardless of the broader economic collapse
- The speakers are personally directing every spare dollar into investments right now — not luxury goods
  - Brandon mentions skipping new watches and cars: "Everything's going into investing right now."

- Recession analogy from 2009: one speaker chose to skip haircuts and instead bought a stock at **$2/share**, later selling at **$44/share** — a **2,200% return**
  - "I laugh. I don't care if somebody laughs. But now, any luxury car I want, any luxury watch I want."

📊 Selling Options Contracts: Better Returns Than a Loan Shark 10:26

- Options contracts — specifically **selling puts** — are described as the most disproportionately profitable legal strategy available
- How it works conceptually:
  - You collect premiums from people who are scared and want insurance on their positions
  - You are the "insurance company," not the buyer
  - Relatively consistent income stream when done correctly
- The loan shark comparison:
  - A mafia loan shark charging **3% per week** sounds impressive — but has enormous overhead: enforcers, bribing police, paying judges, legal risk, prison risk
  - Selling options can generate **better returns** with none of that overhead or criminal liability
- Important caveat (stated explicitly): **This is not free money and not a get-rich-quick scheme**
  - "You got to know what you're doing."
  - "People trying to get rich quick tend to go broke quick."
- Brandon credits this strategy (learned from co-host Derek Moneyberg) with generating **hundreds of thousands of dollars** for him personally
- Utilities ownership tie-in: the speakers joke that natural gas pipelines and utility infrastructure they own are literally powering the homes of listeners right now

💡 Mindset, Discipline, and Personal Backstory 7:44

- The core argument: laziness and ignorance are now **catastrophically expensive**
  - "The cost of stupidity is too high for me. I can't afford it."
  - "The cost of laziness is skyrocketing. The people that were lazy are going to be super poor, man. Like third world poor."
- Personal backstory shared to establish credibility and empathy:
  - Grew up with a mother who was not a good financial planner
  - Experienced periods with no food, unpaid bills, power and phone being shut off
  - That pain became the motivation: "That pissed me off enough that I was like, all right, I want to do whatever it takes to make sure I don't spend my life this way."
- The speakers are not mocking people for being in a bad financial spot — they mock only those who are **content to stay there**
  - "I'm not making fun of them for the spot they're in. I'm making fun of the ones who are okay to stay in that spot."

- The AI displacement wave is framed as the **single biggest danger in most people's lives right now**, whether they recognize it or not
  - "If you ain't where you want to be, that means you got work to do."
- Closing philosophy: "I'm happy to help people that are happy to help themselves."